

Maryland AI Community of Practice (MDAI)

04/17/2026

Agenda

1. **Welcome and Introduction to the AI CoP** (Lauren Maffeo, DoIT)
2. **AI in Design: MD Benefits Exploration** (Laura Ellena, Ling (Veronica) Ng, and Jen Strickland, MD Benefits)
3. **Building a Gem for Social Equity Licensing** (Elizabeth Leo, MD Cannabis Association)
4. **What's Next** (Lauren Maffeo, AI Enablement)



CoP Etiquette

- Mics on Mute to prevent background noise
- Only the speaker should have their camera on to avoid visual distractions
- Add your questions to the Comments or Q&A section of our chat
- The AI Enablement Team will try and address questions in the chat async
- Forward this meeting to peers who might benefit (<https://meet.google.com/cbi-iazh-ccn>)
- Bring an owner's mindset & participate!



MDAI's Vision & Values

Maryland's Vision for AI

The State of Maryland responsibly, ethically, and productively leverages AI/ML technologies to significantly improve constituent outcomes and reduce drudgery for the State workforce.

MDAI's Values

1) Collaborate Across Teams

- Meet regularly to share AI use cases, wins, struggles, questions, and best practices.
- Provide shared space for anyone in Maryland to learn how they can harness AI.
- Connect with peers who have the same issues or aspects of AI enablement as you do.

MDAI's Values

2) Show, Don't Tell

- Host lunch n' learns to show how Maryland's civil servants can use enterprise AI tools.
- Share AI proofs of concept to demo how your peers use AI.
- Highlight guest speakers beyond government to share new AI innovations.

MDAI's Values

3) Provide AI Updates in a Shared Space

- Share new AI policies, processes, guidance, etc. for state employees to use.
- Offer blueprints for anyone serving Maryland (city, county, state, etc.) to leverage AI.
- Provide Maryland's AIE team as a foundational source for where to start with AI.



AI in Design: MD Benefits Exploration

Laura Ellena, Jen Strickland, Ling (Veronica) Ng

MD Benefits explored AI use for design

- UX and prototyping
- Plain language
- User research
- Product development and management
- Translation

UX and prototyping

- Figma
- JavaScript for HTML prototypes
- Explored other AI design tools: [Retool](#), [UX Pilot](#), [Builder.io](#), [UX Pilot Figma Plugin](#), [Cursor](#), [Claude](#)
- However, it's important to know enough to verify.
“... asked [Claude \(prompts and responses\)](#) to provide code for a basic responsive web page, using semantic HTML, prioritizing Section 508 compliance and web performance best practices. Inspected the code afterwards, asked it why it skipped heading levels and used role="img" for a section. It admitted it made errors. Then, I gave the same prompt to [Gemini \(prompts and responses\)](#) and it got it right.”

Figma AI capabilities

- Figjam + Copilot + Adobe → Copilot summarize detailed user flow diagram into story format used to explain complex flow
 - Figma Make
 - Clean up variables etc in dev mode
 - Connected USWDS design library to generate layouts
 - CJAMS explored Make for time-consuming but necessary task of creating mockups with realistic data, different states, and interactivity, don't produce interactive mockups now because of time/LOE
 - Generated code for dev, auto-layout template from screenshot, interactive inline record, prototype/mockup from story requirements
- “It's super easy to generate interactions and visual effects with Make.”

UX and prototyping

Figma Make example

Used Figma Make to generate interactive expandable inline record (first record)



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UX and prototyping

JavaScript for HTML prototypes

- Hand-coded semantic HTML wireframes, but lack JavaScript (JS) skills to add interactivity.
- Used CoPilot to generate initial JS, then knew enough to edit it

```
910 </script>
911
912 (function() {
913   const table = document.getElementById('summary-eligibility-financial');
914   const controlsContainer = document.getElementById('columnControls');
915   const headers = table.querySelectorAll('thead th');
916   const lastIndex = headers.length - 1;
917
918   headers.forEach((header, index) => {
919     // Skip first and last columns
920     // If (index === 0 || index === lastIndex) {
921       return;
922     }
923     // Skip first column
924     if (index === 0) {
925       return;
926     }
927   });
928
929   // none;
930
931   to container
932
933   controlsContainer.appendChild(wrapper);
934   });
935   });
936 </script>
```

```
899 <script>
900 document.addEventListener("DOMContentLoaded", function() {
901   const mainRows = document.querySelectorAll("tr.main-row");
902
903   mainRows.forEach(row => {
904     row.addEventListener("click", function() {
905       const detailRow = row.nextElementSibling;
906       const arrow = row.querySelector(".arrow");
907
908       if (detailRow && detailRow.classList.contains("detail-row")) {
909         const isVisible = detailRow.style.display === "table-row";
910         detailRow.style.display = isVisible ? "none" : "table-row";
911         arrow.classList.toggle("down", !isVisible);
912       }
913     });
914   });
915 });
916 </script>
917
918 <script>
```

Plain language

- Gemini has been great at revising draft text into plain language. Providing parameters to guide (like a link to [plainlanguage.gov](https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language) (<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>) as a resource when prompting is necessary. Review, of course.
- Flesch Kincaid Calculator or Hemingway App can be used to show how readable your text.
<https://charactercalculator.com/flesch-reading-ease/>
- Using HemingwayApp and Gemini, as well, to revise <https://hemingwayapp.com/>

User research

- Generated synthetic users from actual user databases
 - Test responses to questions
 - Run through use cases/test scenarios
 - Run pilots
- AI summaries for transcripts

Product development and management

- This is a to-be-explored area for us.
- Can AI for generate product requirements from raw transcripts?
- Can it help improve user stories?

Translation

- Previously: Google Translate widget
 - It did a bad job, we had to take it down.
Current process: very manual.
- Pilot getting started with U.S. Digital Response (USDR) and Labor Family & Medical Leave Insurance (FAMLI) team
 - AI translation tech: plain language and subject matter glossaries fed in
 - Process: how content is fed into translation, put into a doc for easy human review, then back into our systems
 - Strong potential for scaling

Things to keep in mind

- Everything we use AI for we review, have responsibility for the work we produce.
- The W3C Positive Work Environment group that Jen is in is [evolving an update](#) to the Code of Conduct to address this, may be of interest.
- The Worldwide Web Consortium (W3C) Advisory Board recently [published a statement](#) on the use of AI in standards work that can inform how we use AI, too.
- **Nothing replaces real codesign with users.**



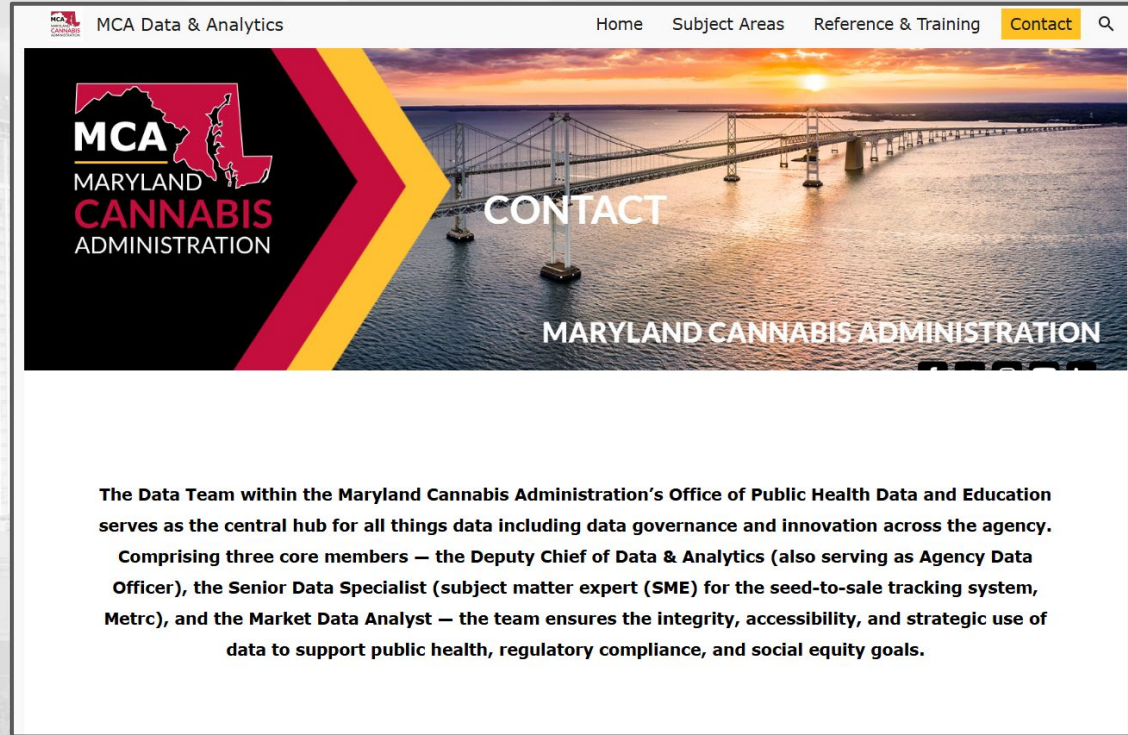
Scaling Compliance Reporting with GenAI

The MCA Social Equity Licensing (SEL) Toolset

Elizabeth Leo

Deputy Chief of Data and Analytics

Our Mission



MCA
MARYLAND
CANNABIS
ADMINISTRATION

CONTACT

MARYLAND CANNABIS ADMINISTRATION

The Data Team within the Maryland Cannabis Administration's Office of Public Health Data and Education serves as the central hub for all things data including data governance and innovation across the agency. Comprising three core members — the Deputy Chief of Data & Analytics (also serving as Agency Data Officer), the Senior Data Specialist (subject matter expert (SME) for the seed-to-sale tracking system, Metrc), and the Market Data Analyst — the team ensures the integrity, accessibility, and strategic use of data to support public health, regulatory compliance, and social equity goals.

The Scale of Oversight

221 Conditional Licenses

21 Regulatory Milestones

1,000s Unstructured Docs

Managing the administrative burden of manual review in order to accurately report on the progress for hundreds of licensees required a strategic shift in data processing.

The Human-First Framework

DIVISION OF REGULATORY AFFAIRS (DRA)



Sovereign Source of Truth: Decisions on licensure eligibility are made exclusively by human Compliance Analysts.



In-Depth Review: Analysts evaluate complex bank statements, property deeds, leases, and zoning approvals.



Formal Documentation: Results are documented in staff correspondence, memos, and status letters stored in Google Drive.



Administrative Aid: AI does not replace this work; it observes and reports on the proof-of-work already completed by staff.

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THE SUMMARIZATION LAYER

WHAT THE AI IS NOT

The SEL script and Gem **do not** perform analytical work or make eligibility determinations. They do not calculate thresholds to "pass" an applicant.

WHAT THE AI DOES

The tools provide a **structured summary** of work done by the DRA. They translate folder activity into actionable progress data for leadership.

Bridging the gap between unstructured documents and executive visibility.

TOOL 1: SEL 2.0 GEM

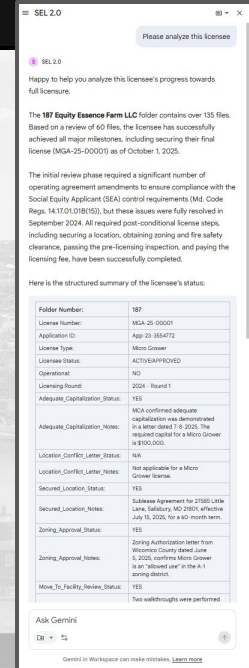
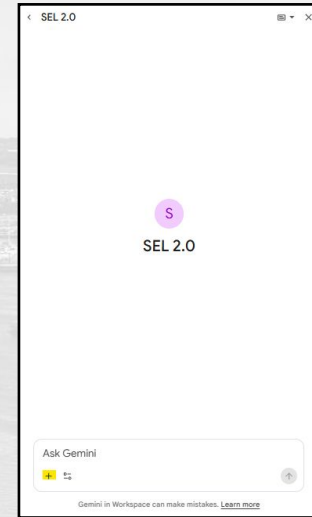
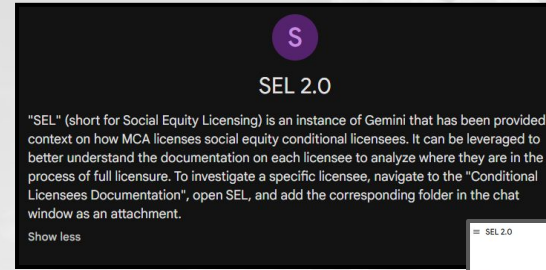
INTERACTIVE STAFF ASSISTANT

 **Ad-Hoc Audits:** Designed for single-licensee deep dives by agency staff.

 **Zero Hallucination:** No guessing, “No documentation found” response rules.

 **Evidence Anchoring:** Provides citations (e.g., [Source: Folder 187, Memo PDF]) for every summarized finding.

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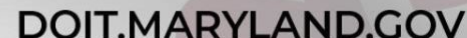
HIGH-SCALE BATCH ENGINE

 **Efficiency:** Processes 221 folders in less than a day.

 **Dashboard Feed:** Directly updates the executive Power BI visualizations.



Maryland
DEPARTMENT OF
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY



Wes Moore - Governor | Aruna Miller - Lt. Governor | Katie Savage - Secretary

[illegible]

INTERNAL LOGIC & GUARDRAILS



SOVEREIGN SOURCE

Prioritizes
"Communications"
folders. If staff memos
exist, AI reports the
human analysis.



LOGICAL INFERENCE

Estimates progress
based on the 21-step
roadmap. Reaching
Step 15 implies Step 8
was satisfied.



GAP DETECTION

Flags missing memos
as "Preliminary
Findings" based on
raw asset math,
alerting staff to
documentation gaps.

THE "STATE-READY" FRAMEWORK

Policy Requirement

Implementation Strategy

Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)

AI generates **drafts** or **flags**; DRA staff must verify accuracy of summary.

Data Privacy

Utilization of Gemini Workspace within @maryland.gov tenant; data is NOT used for public training.

Transparency

"Source Anchoring" - Every conclusion must cite the specific document (e.g., [Source: Folder 31, Bank_Stmt.pdf]).

Risk Classification

Classified as "Limited Risk" application focusing on drafting and summarization.

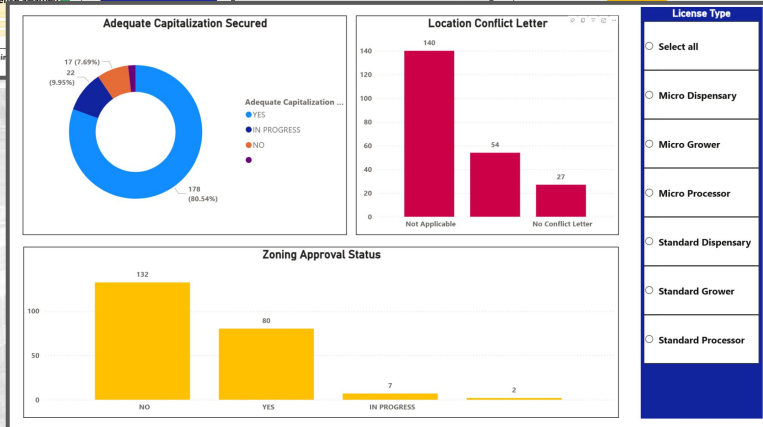
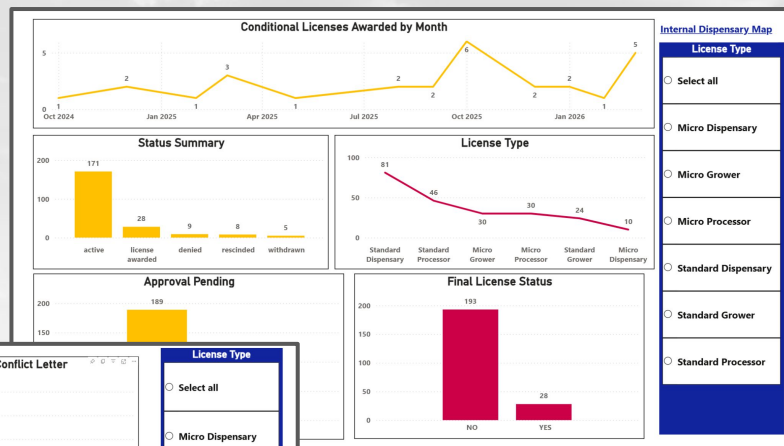
THE FINAL ANALYSIS REPORT

STRUCTURED OUTPUT FOR POWER BI

Folder_Nu mber	License_Nu mber	Application_I D	License_Typ e	Licensee_ Status	Licensee_Na me	Licensing_ Round	Adequate_ Capitalizat ion_Status	Adequate_Capi talization_Note s	Location_Co nflict_Letter_ Status	Location_Co nflict_Letter_ Notes	Secured_L ocation_St atus	Secured_L ocation_No tes	Zoning_Ap proval_Sta tus	Zoning_Ap proval_Not es
1	DUM-24-000 01	App-24-00000 01	Standard Dispensary	active	Dummy Co 1 LLC	Presentatio n Round (2026)	YES	Capitalization verified.	No Conflict	Clear to proceed.	YES	123 Presentation St	YES	Zoning approved by county, documentat ion in X folder..
2	DUM-24-000 02	App-24-00000 02	Micro Grower	active	Example Business LLC	Presentatio n Round (2026)	YES	Personal funds verified.	No Conflict		NO	Seeking location.	NO	
3	DUM-24-000 03	App-24-00000 03	Standard Processor	awarded	Presentation Sample Inc.	Presentatio n Round (2026)	YES	Fully capitalized.	No Conflict		YES	456 Demo Ave	YES	Approved by city, zoning approval document available.

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DOCUMENTATION

[Cannabis Licensee Progress Automated Analysis
Guidance Document](#)

[SEL Gem User Guide: Social Equity Licensing Assistant](#)

[SEL Gem Description and Instructions](#)

KEY TAKEAWAYS FOR THE COP

- ✔ **Start with Sovereign Sources:** Prioritize official staff communications over raw, messy data to reduce error rates.
- ✔ **Build for the Exception:** Use "Conflict Flags" to alert humans when AI sees a discrepancy between data sources.
- ✔ **Policy as a Feature:** Frame compliance (HITL, Citing) as a tool to build trust with staff, not just a checkbox.
- ✔ **Authorized Access:** Use authenticated tokens for all automated scripts to ensure secure API access.

Title

Placeholder



What's Next?

- We meet each 1st Friday per month
- Forward this invite to colleagues who might be interested in joining
- [Submit your AI use cases](#) to our inventory
- [Book MDAI Office Hours](#)
- Email AI@Maryland.gov to show your team's AI work at a future CoP!